

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A K 7 3

♥ 8 4 2

♦ J 9 3

♣ 10 8 4

♠ 10 6 4

♥ K Q 7

♦ 8 6

♣ J 7 5 3 2



♠ 9 8 2

♥ 5

♦ Q 10 7 4 2

♣ A K 9 6

♠ Q J 5

♥ A J 10 9 6 3

♦ A K 5

♣ Q

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

It's a good thing you stopped at game - partner's hand is about as bad as it could be.

The PLAN turns out simple. You can't avoid either of the three black losers so you must eliminate the ♦ loser. You can ruff it in dummy. Just to be safe you pull one more round of trumps, then play ♦A, ♦K and ♦5, ruffing in dummy. You will eventually get to your hand (with a ♠ or a ♣ ruff) and pull the last trump.

This PLAN was not difficult.

Only a real beginner would have pulled all the trumps and not been able to ruff that ♦.

You have a nice hand, but 20 points is not strong enough to open 2♣.

So you open 1♥. Partner raises to 2♥.

Partner's raise to 2♥ shows 6-10 points. You figure that should be enough for game but even if he has the full 10 you are not in slam range. So you bid the game.

South plays 4♥. West leads ♠A, then switches to ♥2.

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Losers: ♠ 2 : ♥ 0 : ♦ 1 : ♣ 1 : Total = 4

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 10 8 2

♥ 10 8 6

♦ 7 5 4

♣ A 5

♠ 7 4

♥ K 5 3

♦ A K 9 6 2

♣ K Q 3



♠ K 6 5 3

♥ Q 9 7 4

♦ 10 8

♣ 9 7 4

♠ A 9

♥ A J 2

♦ Q J 3

♣ J 10 8 6 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

1♦

Pass

1♣

Pass

3NT

Pass

1NT

All Pass

3NT by South

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠Q. East puts on the ♠K.

Winners: ♠ 1 : ♥ 2 : ♦ 5 : ♣ 0 : Total = 8

Let's say you hold up on the first ♠, hoping they switch suits. HA! They aren't about to switch suits and they drive out your ♠A at trick 2. That actually clears the situation up and makes this plan pretty simple to make.

You have taken 1 ♠, and you will surely make 5 ♦s. Despite the solidity of those ♣s you dare not try to win a ♣ trick, because the defenders will pounce on that first ♣ and then win a bunch of ♠ tricks.

So that makes it clear that you need 3 ♥ tricks, and there's only one way to get them. After taking your five ♦ tricks, play a ♥ to the ♥K, then a ♥ back, finessing the ♥J. Half of the time you will make this contract, the other half of the time they will bury you with ♠s.

You might think if you could just sneak one ♣ through you wouldn't have to depend on the ♥ finesse. But put yourself in West's chair. Do you really think he will let you win a ♣ when he sees he can defeat you by taking his ♣A and leading ♠ winners?

With 16 points as Responder you are not quite strong enough for a jump-shift to 2♦. That requires at least 17 points. A jump to 3NT fits the point range (16-18) but promises a stopper in all unbid suits. So instead you bid 1♦, knowing partner is forced to keep the bidding alive. He now replies 1NT. What is your next bid?

Until now you were thinking the hand might end up in a slam. Now, with partner's minimum rebid, you happily say 3NT which partner passes.

North would play 3NT.

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South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠Q. East puts on the ♠K.